

Cleo the Kitten and the Lost Button

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Cleo was a fluffy gray kitten. She lived in a cozy barn. Cleo had a favorite toy. It was a red button on a string. She batted it every morning. She chased it every afternoon. She slept with it every night. Cleo loved her button.



One windy morning, Cleo woke up. Her button was gone! She looked under her blanket. No button. She looked behind the hay bales. No button. Cleo felt worried. Her tail puffed up big. "My button is lost!" she cried. She felt sad. A tear rolled down her whiskers.



Her friend Otto the owl hooted softly. Owls are good at finding things. "What did you lose, little one?" asked Otto. "My red button!" said Cleo. "It was here when I fell asleep." Otto blinked his big round eyes. "Then we will search together," he said. "Look with love, and you will find." "Look with love, and you will find." Cleo repeated it slowly. "Look with love, and you will find." It became their searching song.



First, they looked in the hayloft. Cleo sniffed every corner. Otto peered with his sharp eyes. No button. Next, they looked by the water trough. A frog waved hello. No button. Cleo felt like giving up. But Otto said, "Look with love, and you will find." So they looked once more. This time, Cleo looked with love. She looked slowly and carefully. And there it was! Her red button, tangled in a cobweb. The wind had blown it there. "HOORAY!" shouted Cleo. She felt joyful. She felt relieved. She hugged Otto tight.



Can you help spot the button? Look left. Look right. Peek behind you! Pretend you found it, just like Cleo. Cleo cleaned her button with her paw. She tied the string in a neat bow. Otto hooted a happy song. Cleo batted her button all afternoon. She was so glad it was home.



That night, the barn was warm and quiet. Cleo curled up in her blanket. Her button rested beside her paw. "Thank you for helping me," she whispered to Otto. "Goodnight, button finder," hooted Otto. Cleo purred a soft lullaby. Purr, purr, purr. The moon shone through the barn window. And Cleo fell fast asleep.

***Moral:** Looking with love and patience helps you find what matters.*

The End